

New player in ebook lending

3M has announced a new Cloud Library ebook lending service to allow users to borrow digital books from their iPads, Nooks and Android-based tablets

Nook Colour partitioning woes

Barnes and Noble's new Nook Colour will have a partition which leaves only 1 GB space for music or movies and upto 4GB for stuff that is purchased on the book and app store

Bazaar

MSI Z68A-GD80

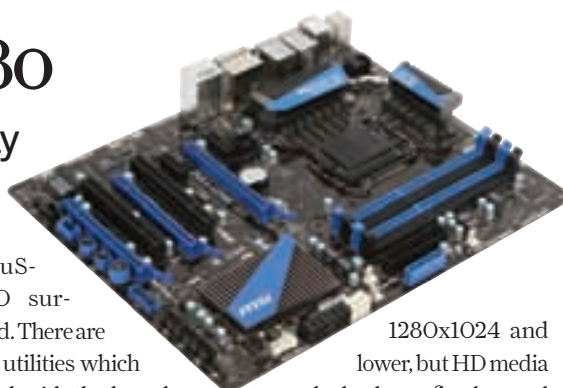
Switchable graphics, finally

Intel's Z68 chipset overcomes the shortcoming of the P67 chipset – which did not allow users to make use of the integrated graphics on Sandy Bridge processors.

On first glance it looks very similar to the P67A-GD65 board except for the display ports. It comes with MSI's standard military class components such as solid state caps, high power chokes, driver MOSFETs among others. The three PCIe x16 slots have enough spacing to be used for a 3-way multi-GPU configuration. A feature which overclockers will love is the dedicated OC II Genie button beside dedicated power and reset switches. It allows you to overclock your processor, integrated graphics and memory on

the fly. It supports THX TruStudio PRO surround sound. There are a bundle of utilities which are provided with the board. Speaking of bundle, MSI offers components such as a USB 3.0 bracket, a range of M connectors, among other regulars. There is a slot for voltage measurement just behind the motherboard's 24-pin ATX power connector.

PC Mark Vantage: 10045 was lower in comparison to P67A-GD65 whereas Cinebench multi-core rendering scores higher than GD65. Real life tests gave similar scores. Switching to integrated graphics gave barely playable frame rates on resolutions of



1280x1024 and lower, but HD media playback was flawless and 100 MB VOB to DIVX encoding took a mere 19 secs. It supports the Lucid Virtu software for switching between discrete and integrated graphics.

It all boils down to features offered, as performance wise is not much different from a P67 board. This board is ideal for those looking to setup a new Sandy Bridge rig or those specifically wanting switchable graphics. At ₹18,500, it is meant for enthusiasts.

Nimish Sawant

Specifications

Socket: LGA1155; RAM: 4 DIMM slots supporting upto 32GB; Back I/O ports: 2xUSB 3.0, 4x USB 2.0, 1x eSATA

Contact

MSI India

Phone: 1800 200 0004

Email: technicalindia@msi.in.com

Web site: www.msi.com

Price: ₹18,500

7.0/10

Features 7.0
Performance 7.0
Build Quality 8.0
Value for money 6.0

Computing Products for eco-conscious Users



ZOTAC
WWW.ZOTAC.COM



GRAPHICS CARDS



MOTHERBOARDS



MINI-PCs

ZOTAC Motherboards
Distributed by:



Neoteric Informatique Pvt. Ltd
Tel : +91-9891282522
sales@neoteric.co.in

ZOTAC Graphics Cards and mini-PCs
Distributed by:



Aditya Infotech Ltd.
Tel : 0120-4555666
sales@adityagroup.com